Sprint Review and Retrospective: SNHU Travel Project

The SNHU Travel project was completed using a Scrum-Agile approach as part of ChadaTech's pilot effort to evaluate Agile development practices. Throughout the project, I served in multiple Scrum roles, including Scrum Master, Product Owner, Tester, and Developer. This Sprint Review and Retrospective summarizes the team's accomplishments, challenges, communication practices, organizational tools, and lessons learned while developing the travel application.

Applying Roles

Each Scrum role contributed to the success of the project. As a Scrum Master, I created the Agile Team Charter and planned Scrum events such as Sprint Planning, Daily Scrums, Sprint Reviews, and Retrospectives. These activities helped establish communication and transparency throughout development.

As a Product Owner, I created and prioritized user stories based on customer requirements. Examples included personalized destination recommendations, vacation budget filters, and a top travel destinations feature. Prioritizing these user stories helped ensure the team focused on delivering the most valuable features first.

As a Tester, I developed test cases for each user's story and revised them after receiving additional information from the Product Owner. This process ensured that features met acceptance criteria and customer expectations.

As Developer, I updated the slideshow application after requirements changed. The original travel destination content was replaced with wellness-focused destinations, demonstrating the team's ability to respond to changing customer needs.

Completing User Stories

The Scrum-Agile approach helped user stories progress through the stages of the software development life cycle efficiently. User stories were first identified and prioritized within the Product Backlog. The team then developed test cases to verify functionality before implementation.

For example, the personalized destination recommendation feature required identifying customer preferences and displaying relevant vacation options. The vacation budget filter allowed users to search for trips within a specific price range, while the top travel destinations feature displayed popular destinations through a slideshow interface. Because Agile focuses on incremental development and continuous feedback, these user stories could be refined and improved throughout the project rather than waiting until the end of development.

Handling Interruptions and Change

One of the most significant changes during development occurred when the Product Owner redirected the project toward detox and wellness vacations. This change affected existing requirements and required updates to user stories, test cases, and application content.
The Scrum-Agile approach allowed the team to respond quickly without restarting the project. Instead of rewriting the entire application, the team updated destination descriptions, priorities, and testing procedures while maintaining existing functionality. This flexibility demonstrated one of Agile's greatest strengths: the ability to accommodate changing requirements even later in development.

Communication

Communication played a critical role throughout the project. As Tester, I communicated with the Product Owner to clarify user stories and request additional information about destination displays and navigation requirements. These communications helped eliminate ambiguity and improve the quality of test cases.

As a Scrum Master, I participated in discussions regarding Agile practices and collaborated with team members to determine which Scrum events and development practices would be most beneficial. Communication was effective because questions were specific, expectations were clearly defined, and team members were encouraged to provide feedback. This collaborative environment helped reduce misunderstandings and support project success.

Organizational Tools and Scrum Events

Several organizational tools and Scrum-Agile principles contributed to the success of the project. The Product Backlog provided a centralized location for prioritizing requirements. User stories helped translate customer needs into actionable development tasks. Test cases ensure that completed functionality meets acceptance criteria.

Scrum events also played an important role. Sprint Planning helped organize upcoming work, Daily Scrums promoted transparency and issue resolution, Sprint Reviews allowed progress to be evaluated, and Retrospectives encouraged continuous improvement. Agile project-management tools such as JIRA could further improve visibility by tracking user stories, tasks, and sprint progress in a centralized environment.

Evaluating the Agile Process

The Scrum-Agile approach provided several advantages throughout the SNHU Travel project. The most significant benefits included flexibility, collaboration, transparency, and the ability to respond quickly to changing requirements. Continuous testing and frequent communication helped identify issues earlier and improve product quality.

However, Agile also presented challenges. The process requires frequent communication and active participation from all team members. Additional meetings and documentation updates can increase workload, particularly when requirements change. During development, improvements could have been made by performing additional testing before submission and ensuring all required source files were included with deliverables.

Overall, Scrum-Agile was the best approach for the SNHU Travel project. The project experienced changing requirements that would have been difficult to manage using a traditional waterfall methodology. Agile allowed the team to adapt quickly, maintain progress, and deliver a working solution despite interruptions and changing priorities.

Conclusion

The SNHU Travel project demonstrated the effectiveness of Scrum-Agile development practices. Through collaboration, communication, iterative development, and continuous feedback, the team successfully completed project objectives while adapting to changing customer needs. Based on the results of this pilot project, Agile would be a strong option for broader adoption within ChadaTech.